Acram A. Latiph

Dr. Acram A. Latiph is a Professor of Economics at Mindanao State University (MSU) in Marawi City and the Executive Director of the Institute for Peace and Development in Mindanao (IPDM). He is known for treating economics and peacebuilding as one job: figure out why some places stay stuck in conflict, then use policy, research, and training to help them get unstuck.

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Education

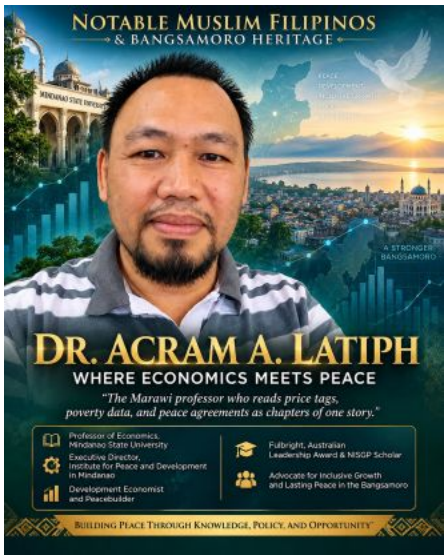
Dr. Latiph took his Bachelor of Science in Economics at San Beda College and his Master of Science in Finance at the University of the Philippines Diliman. At the Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs at Syracuse University in New York, he completed an Executive Master of Public Policy and an Advanced Certificate in Conflict Resolution. His PhD in Development Economics came from the Australian National University (ANU).

His dissertation, "What's Wrong with Mindanao? The Unequal Development in the Philippines," examined the structural economic gaps behind the region's uneven progress. It was nominated for the ANU Award for Academic Excellence. He is a recipient of the Fulbright Scholarship, the Australian Leadership Award, and the NISGP Scholarship.

Academic Career

Dr. Latiph teaches in the Department of Economics at MSU Marawi. His research covers rural development, fiscal autonomy, poverty alleviation, Islamic economics and finance, political economy, regional planning, and the prevention of violent extremism, all with a focus on the Bangsamoro and Muslim Mindanao.

Dr. Acram A. Latiph



Position

Professor of Economics and Executive Director, Institute for Peace and Development in Mindanao (IPDM), Mindanao State University, Marawi City

Education

BS Economics (San Beda College); MS Finance (University of the Philippines Diliman); Executive Master of Public Policy and Advanced Certificate in Conflict Resolution (Syracuse University); PhD Development Economics (Australian National University)

Honors

Fulbright Scholarship; Australian Leadership Award; NISGP Scholarship

Research Interests

Rural development, fiscal autonomy, poverty alleviation, Islamic economics and finance, political economy, peace and conflict studies

Notability

Economist and peace institute head whose training at San Beda, UP Diliman, Syracuse, and ANU, policy advice to Lanao del Sur and BARMM, and campus peace programs tie household economics to lasting peace in the Bangsamoro.

Known For

Leading IPDM's peace education, peace research, and peace action programs; his doctoral study "What's Wrong with Mindanao?"; and practical price-shock

Institute for Peace and Development in Mindanao

recommendations to Lanao del Sur's crisis committee in 2026.

Pull Quote

"Education is a powerful catalyst for transformation."

The MSU Board of Regents created IPDM in December 2001. Today it serves as the central coordinating unit for the university's peace and development programs. Under Dr. Latiph, it runs three programs: peace education, peace research and conflict studies, and peace action. The institute's larger aim is to help the MSU System grow into a National Peace University.

Much of the work happens on the ground. IPDM has partnered with UNDP Philippines on peace education training for MSU campuses. It works with the Office of the Presidential Adviser on Peace, Reconciliation and Unity (OPAPRU) to implement and monitor educational assistance for the children and next-of-kin of decommissioned MILF combatants. At one of those turnovers, Dr. Latiph said that education is a powerful catalyst for transformation.

With World Vision, IPDM trained barangay Lupon representatives in conflict transformation and moved to place the partnership under a formal Memorandum of Agreement. In July 2024, the institute welcomed the Indonesian Leimena Group to Marawi, where the discussions covered preventing and countering violent extremism and a proposed Youth Peace Security certificate course.

Policy Work and Consultancy

Dr. Latiph serves as a consultant and resource person for government institutions, international organizations, and civil society groups, including the Lanao del Sur provincial government and BARMM authorities. His contributions include development plans, poverty alleviation measures, socioeconomic impact assessments, and studies on peace, conflict, and violent extremism.

On March 23, 2026, he presented an economic risk analysis to the Lanao del Sur Provincial Economic Crisis Management Committee, which Governor Mamintal A. Adiong Jr. created after fuel costs climbed. He explained that the province relies on supply routes through Iligan and Cagayan de Oro and has limited local production, so price swings reach households quickly.

His recommendations were practical: expand access to affordable rice, strengthen links with local producers, and provide targeted fuel assistance for transport workers, farmers, and fisherfolk. For government operations, he proposed trimming fuel allocations for nonessential activities and adopting a four-day workweek, which the provincial government has begun implementing.

Commentary on the Bangsamoro Elections

When the Bangsamoro held its first parliamentary elections on September 14, 2026, Dr. Latiph shared his reflections in an interview with CounterCheck. He traced the road from the 1976 Tripoli Agreement, signed under President Ferdinand Marcos Sr., to this milestone under President Ferdinand Marcos Jr. He also recalled that he never imagined former MILF commanders would one day take part in elections through institutions the peace process created.

He welcomed the voter turnout, which the Commission on Elections placed at 84.34 percent, and noted that Lanao del Sur voted peacefully and in an orderly manner. To him, the inaugural election is a milestone and not the destination, and the real work is building a mature, resilient, and accountable democracy.

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